A-A-1223A
July 2, 1987
SUPERCEDING
A-A-1223
August 13, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAG, LAUNDRY (WATER SOLUBLE PLASTIC)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification L-B-1283.

Salient characteristics.

The bags shall be made from either cold or hot water soluble polyvinyl alcohol film, and shall be available in two sizes as specified below:

Type I - Cold water soluble
Type II - Hot water soluble

Size 1 - 28 inches wide by 39 inches high
Size 2 - 36 inches wide by 39 inches high
Tolerances = ± 1/2 inch

The polyvinyl alcohol film shall have a thickness of 0.0014 ± 0.0002 inch.

The Type I bags shall be soluble in water at 55 degrees Fahrenheit and above. The internal tear resistance of the cold water soluble film shall be a minimum of 400 grams at 50 ± 2 percent relative humidity, and a minimum of 250 grams at 95 ± 2 percent relative humidity tested in accordance with ASTM D 1922.

The Type II bags shall be soluble in water at 140 degrees Fahrenheit and above. The internal tear resistance of the hot water soluble film shall be a minimum of 500 grams at 50 ± 2 percent relative humidity tested in accordance with ASTM D 1922.

The bag shall be a standard commercial flat rectangular shape, designed to open across one end of its width without difficulty. Each bag shall have a closure tie made from a single thickness of water soluble film in the manufacturer's standard commercial color. The closure tie shall be securely attached to the bag by the method normally used by the manufacturer.

The minimum length of the closure tie shall be equal to the length of the bag. The bag seams shall be securely sealed, color coded and trimmed in accordance with normal commercial practice.

FSC 8465

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Workmanship. The bags shall be free from any weakening defects such as tears, pinholes, foreign matter, irregular creases, improperly sealed seams, or any other defects which would affect serviceability.

Quality Assurance:

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling. The laundry bags shall be sampled and inspected in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, `Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes', for conformance to the construction, dimensions, workmanship and testing requirements herein, using special inspection level S-2, AQL 4.0 defects per hundred units. Any deviation from the dimensional requirements shall constitute a defect.

Lot size. All bags of the same type and size presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes for inspection.

Tests:

Tear resistance. Test specimens shall be cut to constant-radius form and tested in accordance with ASTM Method D 1922.

Film disintegration. A specimen of film shall be cut to a constant-radius form in accordance with ASTM D 1922 from the same bag the tear resistance test specimens were obtained. In addition, a specimen the full width of the tie closure and 1.25 to 1.5 inches long shall be cut from the bag's tie closure. A petri dish shall be filled approximately 3/4 full of water of the specified temperature (55 degrees Fahrenheit minimum for the Type I bags and 140 degrees Fahrenheit minimum for the Tyep II bags). A single specimen shall be carefully placed upon the surface of the water in such a manner to prevent the film folding back upon itself. The specimen shall be visually observed for signs of disintegration within the specified time (40 seconds for Type I and 50 seconds for Tyep II). Failure to show signs of disintegration within the time and at the water temperature specified shall be cause for rejection.

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Examination for preparation for delivery. A random sample of unit, intermediate and shipping containers (as applicable) shall be selected from each lot and examined for conformance with the preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking required in the contract or order. Samples shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection level II, AQL 6.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred unit.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Governments policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. In addition to the requirements specified in the contract or order the following requirements shall be fulfilled. The bags shall be individually folded at least three times for storage and handling convenience, and shall be packaged in unit packages of 25 bags each. The unit packages shall be enclosed in a polyethylene bag or wrap and waterproof sealed. A card or sheet with instructions describing the proper use and storage conditions for the bags shall be affixed to the outside of each unit package or, alternatively, placed on the inside of the unit package with the instructions facing outward and clearly legible. The card or sheet shall include the type (cold (I) or hot (II) water soluble), size, and month and year packed.

Notes. Purchasers should specify size, and whether hot or cold water soluble bags are required.

The issues of ASTM D 1922 and MIL-STD-105 in effect on the date of the solicitation or purchase order shall be used to determine compliance with the requirements stated herein.

ASTM Standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

Copies of MIL-STD-105 may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

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